



HR Notices, Announcements & Acknowledgements

— User Guide

Module: `odomate_hr_notices` · Odoo 19.0 · Version 19.0.1.0.0

Table of contents

1. What this module does
2. Installation
3. Roles and access
4. Configuration
5. Publishing an announcement
6. Acknowledgement tracking
7. Audience rules
8. Date reminders
9. The systray counter
10. Automatic expiry
11. Field reference
12. Limitations

1. What this module does

HR publishes announcements to a chosen audience. Employees see only the announcements addressed to them, and only while those announcements are published and inside their display window. Employees can press **Acknowledge**, and HR can see exactly who has and has not pressed it.

Separately, HR can save **date reminders** — a saved question such as "which work permits expire in the next 30 days" — and see a live count of matching records.

2. Installation

1. Copy `odomate_hr_notices` into your Odoo addons path.
2. Activate developer mode, then **Apps** → **Update Apps List**.
3. Search for HR Notices and click **Install**.

The module depends on `base`, `mail` and `hr`. Odoo installs any missing dependency automatically.





3. Roles and access

The module invents no new security groups. It reuses three standard ones:

Group	Announcements	Categories	Reminders
<code>base.group_user</code> (every internal user)	Read only, and only published, in-window announcements addressed to them	Read only	No access at all
<code>hr.group_hr_user</code> (HR Officer)	Read, write, create; send for approval; refuse	Read, write, create	Read, write, create
<code>hr.group_hr_manager</code> (HR Administrator)	Everything above, plus Publish and delete	Full	Full

Two protections are worth calling out:

- **Publishing is checked in the method**, not just hidden in the view. An HR Officer who calls `action_publish` directly gets an `AccessError`.
- The acknowledgement fields (`acknowledged_employee_ids`, `acknowledged_count`, `audience_count`, `pending_employee_ids`) carry `groups='hr.group_hr_user'` **on the field itself**, so a non-HR user cannot read them even through a direct ORM call.

Employees never get write access to announcements. Acknowledgement happens through the **Acknowledge** button, which performs one narrowly-scoped privileged write and nothing else.

4. Configuration

Employees → Configuration → Announcement Categories

Create the categories you want to sort announcements by. The demo data ships four: Policy, Safety, Social and Benefits. Each category has a colour used by the colour picker. Deleting a category never deletes announcements — the announcement's **Category** field is simply emptied (`ondelete='set null'`).

5. Publishing an announcement

Employees → Notices → All Announcements → New

1. Fill in **Title**, pick a **Category** and a **Priority** (Low / Normal / High / Urgent, shown as the standard star widget).
2. Set **Display From** and **Display Until**. A start date in the past is allowed — you can correct yesterday's announcement.
3. Choose the **Audience** (see section 7). The form reveals only the field that matches your choice.
4. Write the announcement body.



5. Click **Send for Approval**. The status moves to Waiting for Approval and a To-Do activity is scheduled for an HR Administrator.
6. An HR Administrator clicks **Publish** — or **Refuse**, which asks for a mandatory reason. The reason is stored in **Refusal Reason** and posted to the chatter.

The status bar shows Draft → Waiting for Approval → Published, with Refused and Expired as side branches. No transition skips a step: you cannot publish a draft directly.

A reference such as `NOTICE/00001` is assigned automatically on creation.

6. Acknowledgement tracking

An employee opening a published announcement sees an **Acknowledge** button. Pressing it is idempotent — pressing it twice records one acknowledgement. The button disappears once pressed.

HR sees an **Acknowledgements** tab with:

- **Acknowledged** — how many people pressed the button.
- **Audience Size** — how many people the announcement is addressed to.
- **Has Not Acknowledged** — the difference, as a list of employees.

Acknowledged is not "read and understood." It is a record of a button press, nothing more. This wording appears in the module's own UI help text as well as [here](#).

Worked example: an announcement addressed to a department of 12 people, of whom 5 have pressed the button, shows Acknowledged = 5, Audience Size = 12, and 7 names under Has Not Acknowledged.

7. Audience rules

One method resolves audience membership, and the record rule, the systray, the employee smart button and the has-not-acknowledged list all reuse it.

Audience	Who it resolves to
Everyone	Every active employee of the announcement's own company, resolved at read time — someone hired after publication is included
Selected Employees	Exactly the employees listed in Employees
Selected Departments	Employees whose department is exactly one of the listed departments — there is no sub-department walk
Selected Job Positions	Employees whose job position is one of the listed ones

A user with no employee record at all still sees **Everyone** announcements for their own company, and nothing else. It never raises an error.

The visibility gate is identical everywhere. Outside HR, an announcement is visible only when its status is Published **and** today falls between Display From and Display Until. Not to its own audience, not to an HR Officer who happened to write it — the record rule enforces it for everyone in `base.group_user`.

8. Date reminders

Employees → Configuration → Date Reminders

A reminder answers a date question and nothing else. It never filters on an amount, a state or a status.

1. **Model** — limited to a whitelist: `hr.employee`, `hr.version`, `hr.applicant`, `hr.leave`. Models that are not installed are filtered out of the list, so a missing `hr_recruitment` cannot break the form.
2. **Date Field** — only fields of type `date` or `datetime` on that model.
3. **Time Window** — one of:
 - Today — the field value is today.
 - Within the next N days — between today and today + N.
 - Between two dates — between the fixed **From** and **To** dates.

The **Matching** stat button shows the live count and opens the matching records. Both the count and the button use the same domain builder, and both run **as you** — you never see records you have no right to read.

Worked example: Model `hr.employee`, Date Field `work_permit_expiration_date`, window Within the next N days with N = 30, evaluated on 9 September 2026, counts employees whose permit expires between 2026-09-09 and 2026-10-09.

9. The systray counter

A bullhorn icon in the top bar shows how many published, in-window announcements are addressed to you that you have **not** acknowledged. Open it to see the list, plus — for HR users only — any saved reminder with a non-zero count. Clicking an entry opens the record.

The counter refreshes when the page loads and each time you open the dropdown. There is no polling and no background traffic.

Everything reachable from the systray is also reachable from the menus. The module works completely with `static/src` deleted.

10. Automatic expiry

A daily scheduled action, **HR Notices: Expire Published Announcements**, moves published

announcements whose Display Until has passed to Expired. It touches nothing in Draft, Waiting for Approval, Refused or already Expired, and has no other side effects — no mail, no activity, no change to acknowledgements.

Expired announcements stay fully visible in HR's records and disappear from employees' lists.

11. Field reference

`ododate.hr.announcement`

Field	Type	Notes
reference	Char	NOTICE/00001, from <code>ir.sequence</code> , read-only
title	Char	Required
body	Html	The announcement text
category_id	Many2one	<code>ondelete='set null'</code>
priority	Selection	0 Low, 1 Normal, 2 High, 3 Urgent
date_start / date_end	Date	Required; <code>date_start <= date_end</code> enforced by a DB constraint
state	Selection	draft / to_approve / published / refused / expired, tracked
audience	Selection	all / employee / department / job
employee_ids, department_ids, job_ids	Many2many	Audience targets, restricted to the announcement's company
acknowledged_employee_ids	Many2many	HR-only field
acknowledged_count, audience_count	Integer	Computed, HR-only
pending_employee_ids	Many2many	Computed, HR-only
is_acknowledged_by_me	Boolean	Computed per user; drives the Acknowledge button
is_for_me	Boolean	Computed + searchable; backs the record rule
company_id	Many2one	Required
refuse_reason	Text	Set only by the refusal wizard

`ododate.hr.reminder`

Field	Type	Notes
name	Char	Required



model_id	Many2one	Whitelisted models only
field_id	Many2one	Date/datetime fields of that model
window	Selection	today / days_ahead / period
days_ahead	Integer	Used when window = days_ahead
date_from, date_to	Date	Used when window = period
preview_count	Integer	Computed, never stored, always evaluated as you

hr.employee (extension)

Field	Type	Notes
notice_count	Integer	Every currently published, in-window announcement addressed to this employee, regardless of acknowledgement — deliberately different from the systray count

12. Limitations

- **Acknowledged means "pressed the button."** It is not evidence that the person read or understood anything, and should not be used as one.
- **Departments do not cascade.** An announcement sent to a parent department does not reach its sub-departments. Add each department explicitly.
- **Reminders answer date questions only.** There is no way to add an amount, state or status condition to a reminder.
- **Reminder time zones.** For `datetime` fields the day boundaries are computed as plain 00:00:00–23:59:59 without a per-user time-zone shift, the same convention Odoo's own date filters use. Records within a few hours of midnight may fall on either side of a boundary for users far from the server's time zone.
- **The systray does not live-update.** It refreshes on page load and on dropdown open; there is no bus or websocket subscription.
- **Non-admin verification is out of scope for OdoMate's test environment,** which has no least-privileged account. The employee-visibility, acknowledge and HR-officer-cannot-publish paths are covered by automated tests, but should also be confirmed on your own install with a real non-HR user.

